The basic rule for assessing planetary condition is: *The better the planet's condition, the better the outcome.* As Jean Baptiste Morin, a sixteenth-century French astrologer, wrote:

> Every planet in good celestial state, such as in its own sign or exaltation or triplicity, oriental to the Sun and occidental to the Moon, free from adverse aspects to malefics, in direct and rapid motion, etc., is said to be a benefic universally and for the whole world, and so will be a benefic for any individual born at that time—in whatever house it may appear—and this is even more certain if it receives the favorable rays of the benefics. For the good or evil of a planet's nature or condition is neither abolished nor altered by the houses but is merely given a specific determination, and the planets are more effective in their action the more their celestial state is in conformity with their natures [...]
>
> Furthermore any planet in adverse celestial state, such as in exile, retrograde, in bad aspect to the malefics, and receiving no good aspects from the benefics, can be considered to be malefic universally and for the whole world and so also for any individual born at that time—no matter in what house it falls by either location or rulership—because such a condition vitiates the planet's nature [...]
>
> Finally a planet in an intermediate state such as peregrine and adversely configured by benefics—or favorably so by malefics—will act in a moderate way in producing good and evil. But one should observe that the more ways a planet is assisted in its celestial state the more good it is likely to produce, but the more ways it is impaired the more it will incline to cause evil.[1]

We will now proceed to unpack this paragraph in the balance of this book. We will present the traditional approach to the planets, signs, solar and lunar phase, and aspects. We will examine the celestial condition of each planet in the example charts, and then you will have the guided opportunity to repeat this process with your own chart. Once we know exactly what we can expect from each planet, in terms of both its strengths and weaknesses, we can then begin the process of interpreting its meaning in a particular chart as we place the planets into the wheel of houses and experiences of the human condition on earth.

In the context of discussing planetary condition, one final but important comment must be made about the terms "good" and "bad" (benefic and malefic, favorable or unfavorable, fortunate or unfortunate, as well as several other sets of synonyms). Modern psychological approaches emphasize that the counseling

1 Jean Baptiste MORIN, *Astrologica Gallica*, 21, 2.2, trans. Baldwin.

Planets are modified towards becoming more masculine or more feminine by the following conditions:[3]

1. ZODIACAL SIGN
2. SOLAR PHASE
3. CELESTIAL LATITUDE
4. QUADRANT LOCATION

Table 7. Gender of Planets

	MASCULINE PLANETS	FEMININE PLANETS
PLANET	*Sun, Mercury, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn*	*Moon, Venus*
	MASCULINIZING CONDITIONS	FEMINIZING CONDITIONS
SIGN	*Aries, Gemini, Leo, Libra, Sagittarius, Aquarius*	*Taurus, Cancer, Virgo, Scorpio, Capricorn, Pisces*
PHASE	*Morning, ahead of Sun*	*Evening, behind the Sun*
QUADRANT	*ASC to MC* *DSC to IC*	*MC to DSC* *IC to ASC*
LATITUDE	*North*	*South*

PLANETS AND GENDER

The GENDER OF THE ZODIACAL SIGN in which a planet is located is the first and most important factor in this evaluation. The masculine signs are Aries, Gemini, Leo, Libra, Sagittarius, and Aquarius, which correspond to the fire and air elements. The feminine signs are Taurus, Cancer, Virgo, Scorpio, Capricorn, and Pisces, which belong to the earth and water elements. Masculine planets act more in accordance with their essential nature when they occupy the masculine signs, while feminine planets act more in accordance with their basic nature when they occupy feminine signs.

Just as it is easier to be ourselves and do our best when we are in an environment that supports and enhances our basic nature, planets also operate better in

3 ANTIOCHUS, *Thesaurus* 1.1; RHETORIUS, *Compendium* 1.1.

PRIMARY SOURCE READINGS FOR PART TWO: SIGNS AND RULERSHIPS

CHARACTERISTICS OF THE ZODIACAL SIGNS

TEUCER	The Twelve Signs (*CCAG* 7, pp. 192–213; trans. HOLDEN in *Rhetorius Astrological Compendia*, Appendix 1).
DOROTHEUS	*Carmen Astrologicum* 1.30: Masculine and Feminine Signs, Eastern and Western, Diurnal and Nocturnal.
MANILIUS	*Astronomica* 2. 150–269.
VALENS	*Anthology* 1.2: The Nature of the Twelve Zodiacal Signs.
RHETORIUS	*Compendium* 3: The Nature of the Twelve Zodiacal Signs.
PTOLEMY	*Tetrabiblos* 1.11: Solstitial, Equinoctial, Solid, and Bicorporeal Signs.
PAULUS	*Introduction* 2: The Twelve Zodiacal Signs.
HEPHAISTIO	*Apotelesmatics* 1: The Name and Power of the Twelfth Parts.
FIRMICUS	*Mathesis* 2.16: The Customs, Natures, and Risings of the Signs and the Winds that are Subject to them.

RULERSHIPS OF THE ZODIACAL SIGNS

DOROTHEUS	*Carmen Astrologicum* 1.1: The Triplicities of Zodiacal Signs and their Lords; the Domiciles of the Planets.
	Carmen Astrologicum 1.2: The Exaltations of the Planets.
VALENS	*Anthology* 1.3: The Sixty Bounds.
PORPHYRY	*Introduction* 5: The Domiciles of the Stars which they also call Zones.
	Introduction 6: Exaltations.
	Introduction 7: Co-rulers (Trigons).
FIRMICUS	*Mathesis* 2.2: The Domiciles of the Stars.
	Mathesis 2.3–4 The Exaltations and Falls.
	Mathesis 2.5: The Decans.
	Mathesis 2.7: The Bounds (Terms).
PAULUS	*Introduction* 3: The Bounds that were Allotted to the Five Revolving Stars in the Twelve Zodiacal Signs.
	Introduction 4: The Faces of the Decans in the Twelve Zodiacal Signs.
	Introduction 5: The Single Degrees (*monomoira*) that the Stars Rule in the Signs.
HEPHAISTIO	*Apotelesmatics* 1.6: The Trigons According to Dorotheus.
	Apotelesmatics 1.7: The Zodiacal Signs in which the Stars Rejoice.
	Apotelesmatics 1.8: Exaltations.
RHETORIUS	*Compendium* 7: Exaltations and Falls.
	Compendium 9: The Sect of the Rulers of the Trigons.
	Compendium 10: The 36 Decans and the *Paranatellonta* and the Faces.

CHAPTER 45

Overcoming

AND HURLING RAYS

OVERCOMING

Every star, the one which is lying on the right triangle or square or hexagon overcomes the one on the left, for it is going towards it. Thus, some star which is in Capricorn prevails, overcoming one in Taurus by trigon figure and one in Aries by tetragon figure and one in Pisces by hexagon figure.—PORPHYRY.[1]

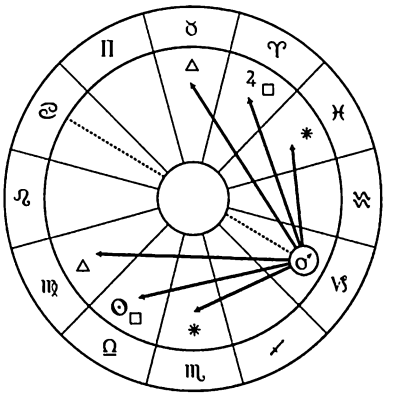


FIGURE 70. OVERCOMING AND HURLING RAYS

A planet in superior position casts forward rays to a planet in inferior position, overcoming any planets in a right-sided sextile, square, or trine (Mars in Capricorn overcomes Jupiter in Aries). A planet in inferior position hurls backward rays to a planet in superior position (Mars in Capricorn casts backward rays to the Sun in Libra, but does not overcome it; instead, the Sun overcomes Mars).

1 PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 21.